

METALWORK

Amulet is shaped like the hammer of the god Thor.



AMULET

The Vikings were capable of intricate metalwork, creating jewelry such as amulets, brooches, and arm rings. Many pieces of Viking jewelry and battle armor have been discovered. Some of these have been found buried together—archaeologists call such findings hoards.

The snake represents a giant serpent, a figure in Scandinavian mythology.



BROOCH



ARM RING

FACT

Around 930, Viking settlers founded the Althing—a general assembly open to all free men—in Iceland. It remains the national parliament of the country to this day.

EXPLORATION ►

The Vikings were expert sailors, and from 700 CE, they developed fast boats called longships for their ocean voyages. Longships were flat-bottomed, which meant they could sail along rivers far inland, and were light enough that they could be dragged onto shore.

Roof made of wooden tiles



▲ LONGHOUSES

Most Viking houses consisted of one large, long room centered around a fireplace, which was used for cooking, heating, and as a source of light. Several generations of the same family would often live in the same house. The image above shows a replica of a Viking longhouse at Fyrkat, Denmark.

The back end of the ship (aft) spirals into the shape of a serpent's tail.

